



K Academy — Student Funding Action Plan

How to get funding approved for students, step by step · UKPRN 10101305 · prepared June 2026

Read this first. Our Level 2–4 courses are Ofqual-regulated VTCT qualifications. That single fact is what makes student funding possible — government money only pays for regulated qualifications, not CPD certificates (so the current Level 5–7 can't be funded yet).

Your UKPRN (10101305) is the entry ticket, not the funding. Each route below is a separate approval. Two routes can go live in days (monthly finance, employer funding); the government and council routes take months and are worth starting now. Work top to bottom — the quick wins first, then the priority loan application.

What is already built on your website

NO ACTION NEEDED

Students can already apply for funding on the site. Here is what they see and where it lands.

WAYS TO PAY

Five ways to fund your course.

Our Level 2–4 courses are Ofqual-regulated qualifications, which is what makes them eligible for government and council funding. Some routes are open today; others we're getting approved — register your interest and we'll tell you the moment they go live.

Monthly course finance

1 AVAILABLE NOW

For Anyone who wants to spread the cost

How You pay in monthly instalments; we are paid up front

Split your course fee into manageable monthly payments through our finance partner. Quick to apply, a soft eligibility check, and you keep your place while you pay it off.

Subject to status and eligibility, 18+, UK residents. Finance is provided by a third party, not by K Academy.

Self-financed/self-funded

LIVE TODAY: monthly finance + self/employer funded

AVAILABLE NOW

For Pay in full, by deposit + balance, or via your employer

How Pay in full, by deposit + balance, or via your employer

Pay for your course directly, or ask your employer to sponsor you. Many clinics and salons fund staff training. We can invoice an employer and provide everything they need.

Advanced Learner Loan

2 REGISTER INTEREST

For Learners aged 19+ on our Level 3 and Level 4 qualifications

How A government loan pays your fees; you repay only once you earn over the threshold

For our Ofqual-regulated Level 3 and Level 4 courses. The loan covers your course fee, is not means-tested, and you only start repaying once you earn above the income threshold — like a student loan. Repayments are written off after the set period if not cleared.

We are applying to offer Advanced Learner Loans. Register your interest and we will contact you the moment our loans facility is approved.

Gov/council routes show "register interest" until each is approved — we never advertise funding we cannot yet provide

REGISTER INTEREST

LIVE chat

The five funding routes on /academy/funding. **AVAILABLE NOW** = monthly finance & employer/self funded. **REGISTER INTEREST** = government/council routes — shown honestly as “coming” until each is approved, so we never advertise funding we can't yet provide.

The 6-question eligibility checker — no credit check.

Personalised result + apply form → lands in Admin → K Academy → Funding and emails your team.

Part 1 — Quick wins (this week)

1 Turn on “pay monthly” course finance

Why: your current Clearpay caps around £1,000 — too low for a £3,500 Level 4. A course-finance partner lets students spread £1.5k–£3.5k over several months and pays you up front. This is the fastest way to remove the price barrier.

1. Pick one course-finance provider and open a free merchant account. Good options for training fees: **Payl8r**, **Tabeo**, **Snap Finance**, or **Knuckle**.
2. During sign-up they give you a **hosted application link** (a web address students click to apply for finance). Copy it.
3. Send that link to your developer and ask them to set the website setting **COURSE_FINANCE_URL** to it (and **COURSE_FINANCE_NAME** to the provider’s name). This is a 2-minute change — no new code.
4. Ask them to also set **ACADEMY_NOTIFY_EMAIL** to the inbox that should receive funding enquiries.

LINKS

Payl8r: payl8r.com/business · Tabeo: tabeo.co.uk · Snap: snapfinance.co.uk/businesses · Knuckle: knucklefinance.co.uk

Leave alone: don’t remove Clearpay — keep it for small amounts. You don’t need to touch any code yourself; the developer flips one setting.

Done when: the “Apply with monthly finance” button on /academy/funding opens your provider’s application page.

2 Confirm your courses are on the funding list (make-or-break check)

Why: everything below only works if your exact VTCT qualifications are approved for funding. This free government tool tells you in 2 minutes.

1. Open the **Find a learning aim** service (link below).
2. If a cookie message appears, click **Hide cookie message**.
3. In **Type of learning** choose **Qualifications**. In **Academic Year** choose the current year.
4. In **Search by title or reference number**, type your course name (e.g. "Certificate in Aesthetic Practice") or its QAN code, then press **Search**.
5. Open your qualification and look at the **Funding** section. Check it lists **Advanced Learner Loans** (for Level 3 & 4) and/or **Adult Skills Fund** (for Level 2 & 3), and note the **last date a learner can start**.
6. Write down, for each course: the **QAN**, which funding it's approved for, and the last start date. If a course you teach is **not** listed, ask VTCT which equivalent regulated qualification **is** funded, and switch funded cohorts to it.

LINKS

Find a learning aim: submit-learner-data.service.gov.uk/find-a-learning-aim · Cross-check (register of regulated quals): qualification.s.education.gov.uk

Done when: you have a one-page list of your QANs and exactly which funding each is approved for. **Send this to me** and I'll switch each website route to "available" at the right time.

You've accepted analytics cookies. You can [change your cookie settings](#) at anytime.

Hide cookie message

 GOV.UK

1 Find a Learning Aim

Find a learning aim

Find the latest information on available Qualifications, Standards, Apprenticeships, T Levels and Units.

Standards will show you information on funding, dates and common components. Qualifications and Units show you funding streams for courses and the last date learners can start. Apprenticeships and T Levels show you pathways, dates, and common components.

Database downloads

[View current downloads](#)

Search by **title** or **reference number**

► [Search using a wildcard](#)

Type of learning

Qualifications ▼

Academic Year

2025 to 2026 ▼

Task 2: the GOV.UK "Find a learning aim" service. Set **Type of learning** → **Qualifications**, pick the year, then search by course name or QAN.

3 Check your details on the UK Register of Learning Providers (UKRLP)

Why: funders pull your legal name, address and contact from UKRLP. If it's out of date, applications stall.

1. Open the UKRLP site and click **Search Providers**.
2. Enter your UKPRN **10101305** and check the name, address and contact are correct and match Companies House.
3. If anything is wrong, click **Update your details** on the homepage and follow the verification steps (you verify as the company's authorised contact).

LINKS

UKRLP: ukrlp.co.uk (the site blocks automated screenshots, so use the link directly)

Done when: UKPRN 10101305 shows your correct current legal name, address and a monitored contact email.

4 Subscribe to ESFA / DfE email updates

Why: new Advanced Learner Loan “facility” windows (Task 7) are announced in this weekly bulletin. Miss the bulletin, miss the window.

1. Open the ESFA/DfE update page (link below).
2. Click **Get emails / Subscribe to updates** and enter your email.
3. Confirm the subscription from the email they send you.

LINKS

ESFA org page: gov.uk/government/organisations/education-and-skills-funding-agency · Update bulletin: gov.uk/government/collect/ons/esfa-update

Done when: you've received the first weekly “DfE Update — further education” email.

Part 2 — Your priority application: your own Advanced Learner Loans facility

LEVEL 3 & 4 · ~6–12 MONTHS

This is the route you chose to lead with. A government loan pays the student's fee; the Student Loans Company pays **you** directly; the student repays later only when they earn over the threshold. You need a “facility” (a contract + a spending limit) from the Department for Education.

5 Read the two rulebooks

Why: so you apply to the right standard and know what you're committing to (audits, learner records, eligibility checks).

1. Open the **Advanced learner loans funding rules 2026 to 2027** and skim sections on who can get a facility and provider responsibilities.
2. Open the **application guidance for a loan facility** and read the eligibility and evidence requirements.

LINKS

Funding rules 26/27: [gov.uk → advanced-learner-loans-funding-and-performance-management-rules-2026-to-2027](https://gov.uk/government/publications/advanced-learner-loans-funding-and-performance-management-rules-2026-to-2027) · Facility application guidance: [gov.uk → advanced-learner-loans-application-guidance-for-a-loan-facility](https://gov.uk/government/publications/advanced-learner-loans-application-guidance-for-a-loan-facility)

Done when: you can state in one line who is eligible (19+, regulated Level 3–6) and what evidence the application needs.

6 Build your “evidence pack”

Why: the DfE assesses your finances, capacity and quality before awarding a facility. Having this ready means you can apply the moment a window opens.

1. Gather **latest accounts / management accounts** and a short **cash-flow forecast** (they check financial health).
2. Write/collect core **policies**: safeguarding, data protection (GDPR), equality & diversity, complaints, and a quality/delivery plan.
3. Document your **delivery model**: tutors and their qualifications, the venue (the clinic), how you assess and how you keep attendance/learning evidence.
4. Note your intended **numbers** (how many Level 3 & 4 learners per year) — this sizes the facility you request.

Heads-up: as a new funded provider you’ll likely get an **Ofsted “new provider” monitoring visit** within the first couple of years. Budget time for compliance, not just the income.

Done when: a single folder holds accounts, forecast, the five policies, the delivery plan and your learner numbers.

7 Submit the first-time facility request (when the window opens)

Why: this is the actual application that gets you the loan contract and spending limit.

1. Watch the ESFA/DfE emails (Task 4) for the **“Advanced Learner Loans — first-time facility request”** window for the funding year.
2. Download the **first-time facility request form** (a spreadsheet) linked from the funding-rules page.
3. Complete it using your evidence pack (Task 6) and submit by the stated deadline.
4. Respond promptly to any DfE due-diligence questions. If offered, also request a **loans bursary** allocation (a hardship fund for low-income learners — strengthens recruitment).

Done when: you receive an **ESFA loans facility agreement** to sign, with an allocation value.

8 Register with the Student Loans Company (Learning Provider Services)

Why: this is who actually pays you and lets students apply for their loan against your courses.

1. Once your facility is agreed, open **SLC Learning Provider Services** and follow the **new providers** onboarding.
2. Set up your provider account and bank details so SLC can pay course fees on the learner’s behalf.
3. Give students the course details they need to apply for their loan (course title, your provider name/UKPRN, fee, dates).

LINKS

SLC Learning Provider Services: lpservices.slc.co.uk

Done when: a test student can select K Academy and your Level 4 course inside their loan application.

9 Set up learner-data reporting

Why: funded providers must report each learner to the DfE (the “ILR”). No report, no payment.

1. Create an account on the **Submit Learner Data** service.
2. Use it (or a small Management Information system / bureau) to submit your learner records on the published schedule.

LINKS

Submit Learner Data: submit-learner-data.service.gov.uk

Done when: you’ve made a first successful learner-data submission (even a test/blank return).

Part 3 — Free training for Londoners (Adult Skills Fund & Islington)

This route makes training **free** for eligible Londoners (19+, unemployed or low-wage) on Level 2/3. London's budget is held by the Mayor of London. New providers usually start by **subcontracting** with a college that already holds the contract.

10 Approach a GLA-funded London college about subcontracting

Why: fastest way to get fully-funded learners through the door without holding your own contract yet.

1. Read the GLA **Information for Adult Skills Fund providers** page so you understand the rules.
2. Make a one-page offer: "Ofqual-regulated Level 2/3 Skin & Laser delivered in a working Islington clinic, into local jobs."
3. Email 2–3 large London FE colleges' **business development** / **subcontracting** teams and ask if they'll subcontract this provision to you.

LINKS

ASF provider info: [london.gov.uk → information-adult-skills-fund-providers](https://www.london.gov.uk/information-adult-skills-fund-providers) · ASF overview: [london.gov.uk → adult-education-budget-aeb](https://www.london.gov.uk/adult-education-budget-aeb)

Done when: at least one college has agreed to explore a subcontract, or told you their next subcontracting round date.

11 Register on the London Tenders Portal

Why: when the GLA or a borough runs a tender for new training provision, this is where it's posted and bid for. Registration is free.

1. Open the **London Tenders Portal** and go to the **Suppliers Area**.
2. Register your company (free) and set your business categories to education/training so you get alerts.
3. Also register on **Find a Tender** for national notices.

LINKS

London Tenders Portal: [londontenders.org](https://www.londontenders.org) · Find a Tender: find-tender.service.gov.uk

Done when: you're registered and receiving tender alerts for training/skills.

12 Contact Islington Adult Community Learning

Why: Islington funds free courses for residents and runs a community-wealth-building agenda (local training → local jobs) that a clinic-based academy fits perfectly.

1. Call or WhatsApp Islington Adult Community Learning on **07734 777466**, or use the contact page below.
2. Ask to speak to the **Adult Community Learning / Inclusive Economy & Jobs** team about a **partnership** to offer funded places to residents.
3. Ask specifically whether current **UK Shared Prosperity Fund (People & Skills)** activity can commission places on your courses.

LINKS

Islington ACL: adultlearning.islington.gov.uk · Contact: [adultlearning.islington.gov.uk → contact](https://adultlearning.islington.gov.uk/contact) · Council adult skills: [islington.gov.uk → adult-skills-training](https://islington.gov.uk/adult-skills-training)

Done when: you've had a first conversation and know who at the council owns adult-skills partnerships.

Part 4 — The 2027 prize: Lifelong Learning Entitlement

LEVEL 4–6 · BIGGEST, SLOWEST

13 Start exploring Office for Students registration

Why: from January 2027 the Lifelong Learning Entitlement gives every adult a flexible loan (~£39,160) for Level 4–6 courses and modules. To use it you must be registered with the Office for Students (OfS). It's the highest bar, so begin scoping now.

1. Read OfS **“How to register with the Office for Students”** (Regulatory advice 3) and the **conditions of registration**.
2. Work through the OfS **registration checklist** and honestly assess whether you can meet the ongoing conditions (quality, finances, governance).
3. Read the SLC **Lifelong Learning Entitlement** provider portal to see what delivering LLE will involve.
4. Decide whether to also make your Level 5–7 a **regulated qualification** (a precondition for funding it).

LINKS

OfS how to register: [officeforstudents.org.uk → how-to-apply](https://officeforstudents.org.uk/how-to-apply) · Conditions: [officeforstudents.org.uk → conditions-of-registration](https://officeforstudents.org.uk/conditions-of-registration) · LLE provider portal: [lpservices.slc.co.uk → lifelong-learning-entitlement](https://lpservices.slc.co.uk/lifelong-learning-entitlement)

Done when: you've made a go/no-go decision on pursuing OfS registration and, if go, requested an application access key.

The screenshot shows the Office for Students website. The header includes the OfS logo, navigation links (Contact us, About, Get involved), and a search bar. The main navigation bar lists: Home, For students, For providers, News, blog and events, Publications, Data and analysis, and Deadlines. The breadcrumb trail reads: Home > For providers > Registering with the OfS > How to register with the Office for Students. The main content area has a dark blue header with 'Regulatory advice 3' in a yellow box and the title 'How to register with the Office for Students'. Below the title, it says 'Published 21 August 2025'. The 'In this briefing:' section contains a 'Table of contents' sidebar with links to Introduction, 1. Understand registration, 2. Eligibility, 3. Plan and submit your application, 4. Assessment, 5. Outcomes, and 6. Applying for changes. To the right of the sidebar are four tiles: 'Read as a PDF' (Download this guidance as a PDF), 'Introduction', '1. Understand registration', and '2. Eligibility'.

Task 13: the Office for Students “How to register” guide. The table of contents (Understand registration → Eligibility → Plan and submit → Assessment) is your roadmap for the 2027 route.

Part 5 — Housekeeping (so we stay compliant)

14 Compliance + “go-live” settings

Why: advertising funding you don't yet hold is against advertising rules; and the funding form collects personal data.

1. Keep every government/council route on the website set to **“Register interest”** until that approval lands. When one is approved, tell me and I'll flip it to **“Available now”** (a one-line change in **lib/funding.ts**).
2. Add a line to your **privacy notice** covering funding-enquiry data (name, contact, employment/income band, residency) and how long you keep it.
3. Confirm with your finance partner who is the lender and that you're operating within the correct consumer-credit permissions; keep on-site finance wording fair and clear.
4. Check **Admin** → **K Academy** → **Funding** weekly and move each enquiry through the pipeline (New → Reviewing → Referred → Approved → Funded).

Done when: the privacy notice is updated and a named person owns the weekly funding-enquiry review.

Prepared for K Academy (KCLINICS SKIN & LASER LIMITED, UKPRN 10101305). Funding rules and thresholds change each year — confirm current-year specifics on the linked GOV.UK / London.gov.uk / OfS pages before you submit. Full background and sources are in the repository at **docs/ACADEMY_FUNDING_STRATEGY.md**; this plan is the step-by-step companion.